

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: RESPONSIBLE EXECUTIVE AND CONSTITUTIONAL CHAIN

### 00. RESPONSIBLE EXECUTIVE AND CONSTITUTIONAL CHAIN

Article 74 creates PM-headed advice

|

v

Article 75 creates responsibility to Lok Sabha

|

v

Article 77 gives formal expression and business rules

|

v

Article 78 preserves the information bridge

ANSWER LINE:

The President supplies constitutional form while the PM-led Council supplies politically responsible executive choice.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: PRIME MINISTER APPOINTMENT, ELIGIBILITY AND CONFIDENCE

### 01. PRIME MINISTER APPOINTMENT, ELIGIBILITY AND CONFIDENCE

Clear majority narrows presidential choice

|

v

Hung House requires objective support material

|

v

Prompt floor test determines survival

|

v

Article 75(5) allows only six consecutive months

ANSWER LINE:

Appointment begins government formation, but Lok Sabha confidence completes democratic authority.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: PRIME MINISTER POWERS AND PRESIDENTIAL RELATION

### 03. PRIME MINISTER POWERS AND PRESIDENTIAL RELATION

Selects ministers and allocates portfolios

|

v

Chairs Cabinet and coordinates policy

|

v

Article 78 channels information to President

|

v

Party and coalition arithmetic condition power

#### ANSWER LINE:

Prime-ministerial authority combines constitutional position with party leadership and remains conditional on confidence.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: COUNCIL, CABINET, RANKS AND THE 91ST AMENDMENT

### Q3. COUNCIL, CABINET, RANKS AND THE 91ST AMENDMENT

Council is the wider constitutional ministry

|

v

Cabinet is the Cabinet-rank decision core

|

v

Ranks are conventional, not a four-rank constitutional code

|

v

Article 75(1A) uses total Lok Sabha membership

ANSWER LINE:

The 91st Amendment disciplines ministry size and defectors without fixing the actual size or ranks of the ministry.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: COLLECTIVE, INDIVIDUAL AND LEGAL RESPONSIBILITY

### 04. COLLECTIVE, INDIVIDUAL AND LEGAL RESPONSIBILITY

Article 75(3): ministry stands or falls together

|

v

Article 75(2): PM enforces individual exit

|

v

Cabinet solidarity requires public defence or resignation

|

v

No universal countersignature does not erase ordinary liability

#### ANSWER LINE:

Responsibility is strongest when confidence, solidarity, personal discipline and legal accountability are kept distinct.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: ARTICLE 77 AND GOVERNMENT BUSINESS

### 05. ARTICLE 77 AND GOVERNMENT BUSINESS

Allocation Rules answer who handles a subject

|

v

Transaction Rules answer how important cases move

|

v

Defined cases escalate to PM, committees, Cabinet or President

|

v

Authentication is not personal presidential decision

#### ANSWER LINE:

Article 77 turns political direction into traceable departmental action through allocation, consultation and escalation.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: CABINET COMMITTEES AND CURRENT CONTROL

### 06. CABINET COMMITTEES AND CURRENT CONTROL

Standing and ad hoc committees specialise Cabinet work

|

v

Cabinet retains the collective-responsibility frame

|

v

Number, membership and chairs vary by notification

|

v

Official composition document is dated 27 July 2026

#### ANSWER LINE:

Cabinet Committees improve specialisation, but current composition must come from the dated official notification.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND INFORMAL SUPPORT

### 02. CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND INFORMAL SUPPORT

Cabinet Secretariat administers business rules

|

v

It records, coordinates and monitors Cabinet decisions

|

v

PMO is non-constitutional staff support without independent competence

|

v

Kitchen Cabinet and GoMs are informal or ad hoc mechanisms

#### ANSWER LINE:

Coordination bodies assist the formal executive but cannot replace ministerial competence or parliamentary responsibility.



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: CARETAKER, COALITION AND CONTINUITY

### 99. CARETAKER, COALITION AND CONTINUITY

PM resignation or death ends the ministry politically

|

v

Article 74 requires continuity until successor assumes office

|

v

Coalition bargaining affects solidarity, not Article 75(3)

|

v

Caretaker restraint is convention, not a separate constitutional code

#### ANSWER LINE:

Political arithmetic changes the intensity of PM power, while constitutional continuity and confidence remain constant.

Question Hour, committees, finance and audit create scrutiny

|

v

No-confidence supplies the collective sanction

|

v

Whip and Tenth Schedule may compress legislative autonomy

|

v

Courts, federalism, elections and Cabinet colleagues constrain dominance

ANSWER LINE:

India shows a prime-ministerial tendency within cabinet government, not a legal replacement of cabinet government.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: PYQ AND PRELIMS TRAP ROUTES

### 10. PYQ AND PRELIMS TRAP ROUTES

Shamsher Singh (1974): responsible advice

|

v

S.R. Chaudhuri (2001): no serial six-month appointments

|

v

2024 GS-II Q3 asks how Cabinet growth marginalises scrutiny

|

v

Article 88 gives participation, not a vote without membership

ANSWER LINE:

High-scoring responses identify the exact provision, reject frozen counts and separate Union rules from State analogues.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: ANSWER EXECUTION, REFORM AND QUALIFIED VERDICT

### 11. ANSWER EXECUTION, REFORM AND QUALIFIED VERDICT

10 marks: provision, mechanism, limitation, verdict

|

v

15 marks: add institutional chain and named evidence

|

v

20 marks: balance concentration against counterweights

|

v

Reforms must target whip, scrutiny, PMO subsidiarity and traceability

ANSWER LINE:

Strong executive coordination earns constitutional legitimacy only when each decision remains traceable to collective responsibility.